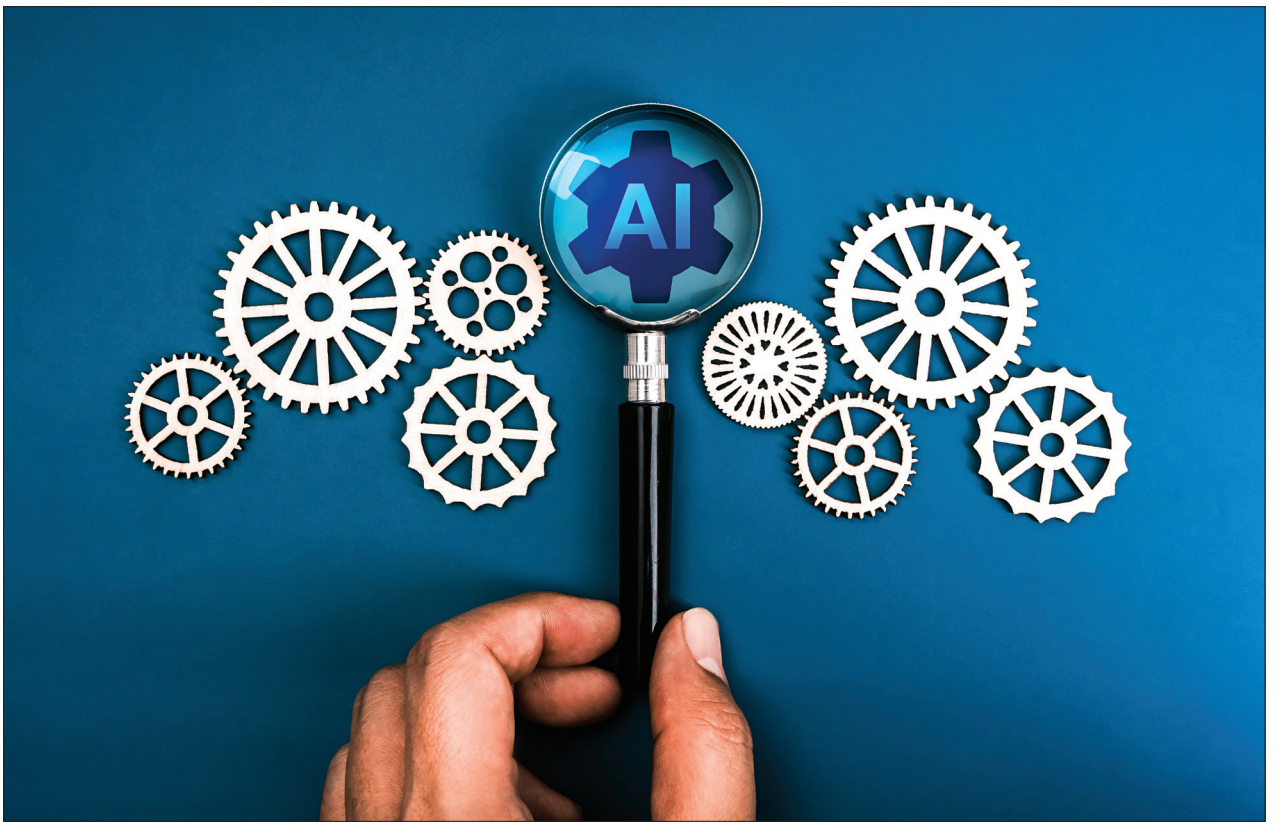


Give Your AI Tools

Connect your model to functions, data and real actions

Until now, our AI has been largely confined to producing text. RAG gave it access to private knowledge, and fine-tuning helped shape how it behaves, but neither lets the model actually perform a calculation, look up a live record, inspect a spreadsheet or trigger a controlled action. For that, we need tools.

A tool is simply a function or service that the application makes available to the model. The model can decide that a tool would help, specify which tool it wants and propose the required arguments. Your application then decides whether that request is valid, executes the function, returns the result and lets the model continue.

That distinction matters. Hugging Face's current tool-use documentation is explicit: the model does not execute the tool itself. It produces a tool call; your software handles the call and adds the result back to the conversation.

The moment we make this separation clear, "AI agent" stops sounding mystical. It becomes software orchestration around a probabilistic model.

Why AI models need tools

Language models are extraordinarily good at generating plausible text. That does not make them reliable substitutes for every program on your computer.

Ask a model to calculate a long tax breakdown mentally and it may err; give it a calculator and the arithmetic becomes deterministic. Ask about current inventory and it needs a live lookup. Ask it to rename fifty files and prose alone accom-